SwimSignal

For event organisers

For triathlons, open water swims and club sessions at a listed spot: the forecast for the day, the storm overflows upstream of the venue, a checklist and a sign to print.

British Triathlon's water quality guidance says that testing a river before an event is likely to be of limited value, and that organisers should understand the overflows upstream and be told when they discharge. SwimSignal forecasts each listed spot from those overflows and the rain, for the day it is issued and the four after it.

River Thames, Port Meadow, Oxford

River · River Thames

Pick the day of your event for its forecast.

Storm overflows upstream

29 monitored storm overflows are within 60 km upstream along the river network: 28 report their status live, and 1 has no live feed, so SwimSignal forecasts it from rain and their yearly record alone. Sewage from the farthest takes about 82 h to arrive.

The table lists the 10 that matter most in the current forecast: the full list of 29 could not be loaded. Try again later.

Overflow	Company	Discharges into	Distance	Travel	Reach	Spills a year	Hours spilling	Live feed
Cassington sewage works overflow Cassington STW	Thames Water	River Thames	4.7 km	7 h	81%	15	0	Yes
Combe sewage works overflow Combe STW	Thames Water	River Evenlode	19.8 km	27 h	17%	60	357	Yes
Standlake sewage works overflow Standlake STW	Thames Water	River Windrush	20.5 km	29 h	16%	60	2214	Yes
Finstock sewage works overflow Finstock STW	Thames Water	River Evenlode	27.8 km	39 h	11%	25	144	Yes

Overflow	Company	Discharges into	Distance	Travel	Reach	Spills a year	Hours spilling	Live feed
Charlbury sewage works overflow Charlbury STW	Thames Water	River Evenlode	31.3 km	44 h	9%	15	52	Yes
Bampton sewage works overflow Bampton STW	Thames Water	Shill Brook	28.5 km	40 h	6%	77	926	Yes
Stanton Harcourt sewage works overflow Stanton Harcourt STW	Thames Water	Harcourt Brook	11.5 km	16 h	5%	69	709	Yes
Church Hanborough sewage works overflow Church Hanborough STW	Thames Water	Hanborough Stream	9.9 km	14 h	4%	84	1236	Yes
South Leigh sewage works overflow South Leigh STW	Thames Water	Limb Brook	12.8 km	18 h	4%	84	927	Yes
Lechlade sewage works overflow Lechlade STW	Thames Water	River Leach	46.2 km	64 h	3%	36	161	Yes

Overflow history, 2021 to 2025: each overflow's spills and spill hours a year.

Distance: upstream along the river network, through any lake on the way; "across the lake" for one that drains into the same lake. **Travel**: how long sewage takes to arrive, at the model's river speed, and across a lake at its slower lake speed. **Reach**: the share of a spill's bacteria the model expects to arrive here, after die-off over the travel time and dilution by the size of the river network upstream. An estimate, not a measured chance. **Spills a year**: its long-term average, from the Environment Agency's annual returns. **Hours spilling**: the total in its latest annual return. **Live feed**: whether its water company reports its status as it happens.

Printed from http://localhost:8791/organisers.html. Look at http://localhost:8791/spot/thames-port-meadow/ for the latest forecast.

Before the event: a checklist

Drawn from British Triathlon's water quality guidance (2025) and Swim England's outdoor swimming guidance for clubs (June 2025). Read both: they cover much more than water quality.

1. **Know what drains into the water.** Early in planning, find the streams, drains and sewage outlets that feed the venue, and the farmland, livestock and birds near it. A spot picked above lists the monitored storm overflows upstream; the landowner, the council or the Environment Agency may know of other outlets.
2. **Be told when the overflows discharge.** Ask the water company how to be notified when the overflows that matter to your venue spill, and watch its live map in the days before.
3. **At a bathing water, read the Environment Agency's page.** From May to September the Agency samples designated bathing waters and publishes the results and any warnings there.
4. **Plan any testing with a laboratory.** A sample shows the water when it was taken, and the result takes at least 48 hours. On a river, testing before the event tells you little, because the water changes with flow and rain; ask a UKAS-accredited laboratory what is worth doing. For a one-off event British Triathlon suggests tests a month, two weeks and a week before, the last in time to change plans.
5. **Take a sample on the day.** The result comes after the event, but it shows the conditions if swimmers fall ill.
6. **Watch the rain.** Heavy rain washes in runoff, makes overflows spill and changes the flow and the water level at the way in and out. The forecast on this page covers the event day from four days before.
7. **Decide the fallback early.** Agree who decides, by when, and what happens instead, such as a shorter or moved course or no swim, and tell swimmers how they will hear.
8. **Look for algae.** Check by eye every week from a month before, along sheltered shores especially.
9. **Tell swimmers the simple precautions.** Cover cuts, do not swim when unwell, wash hands before eating, and shower and rinse kit afterwards.
10. **After the event.** Anyone who is ill in the three weeks after should contact their GP or NHS 111 and say that they swam in open water, and where.

The terms of use say what reuse they allow, and what SwimSignal takes responsibility for when it is used to run an event.

SwimSignal is a free, non-commercial pollution risk forecast for river and lake swim spots in England, run by Ethan Buckley. A forecast, not a water test: check the signs at the water before you swim.